

Economic Convergence in the Eurozone (2000–2023)

Country

- Select all
- Belgium
- France
- Germany
- Italy
- Spain

1,31

Average GDP Grow...

2,07

Average Inflation (%)

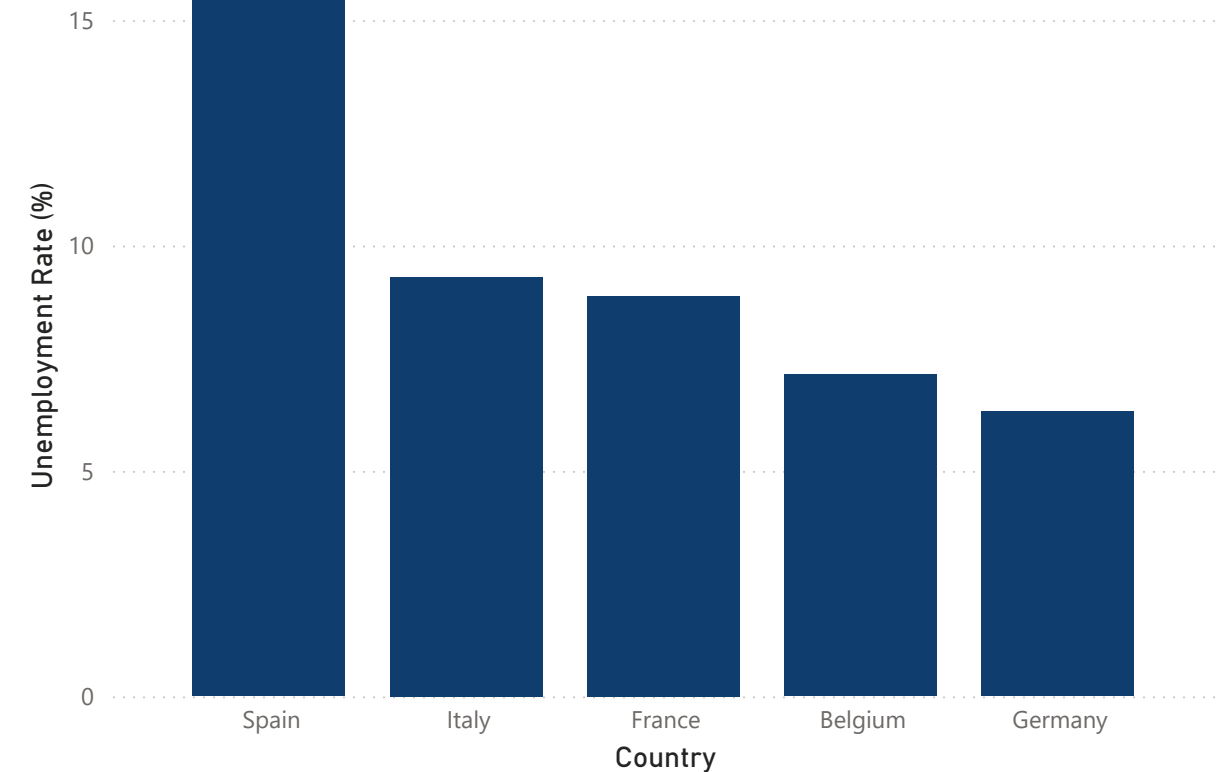
9,44

Average Unemploy...

Key findings

A common monetary policy is not enough to ensure convergence. Germany consistently outperforms on unemployment and inflation stability, while Spain and Italy face deeper structural challenges. France and Belgium hold a stable intermediate position, national fiscal and structural policies remain decisive.

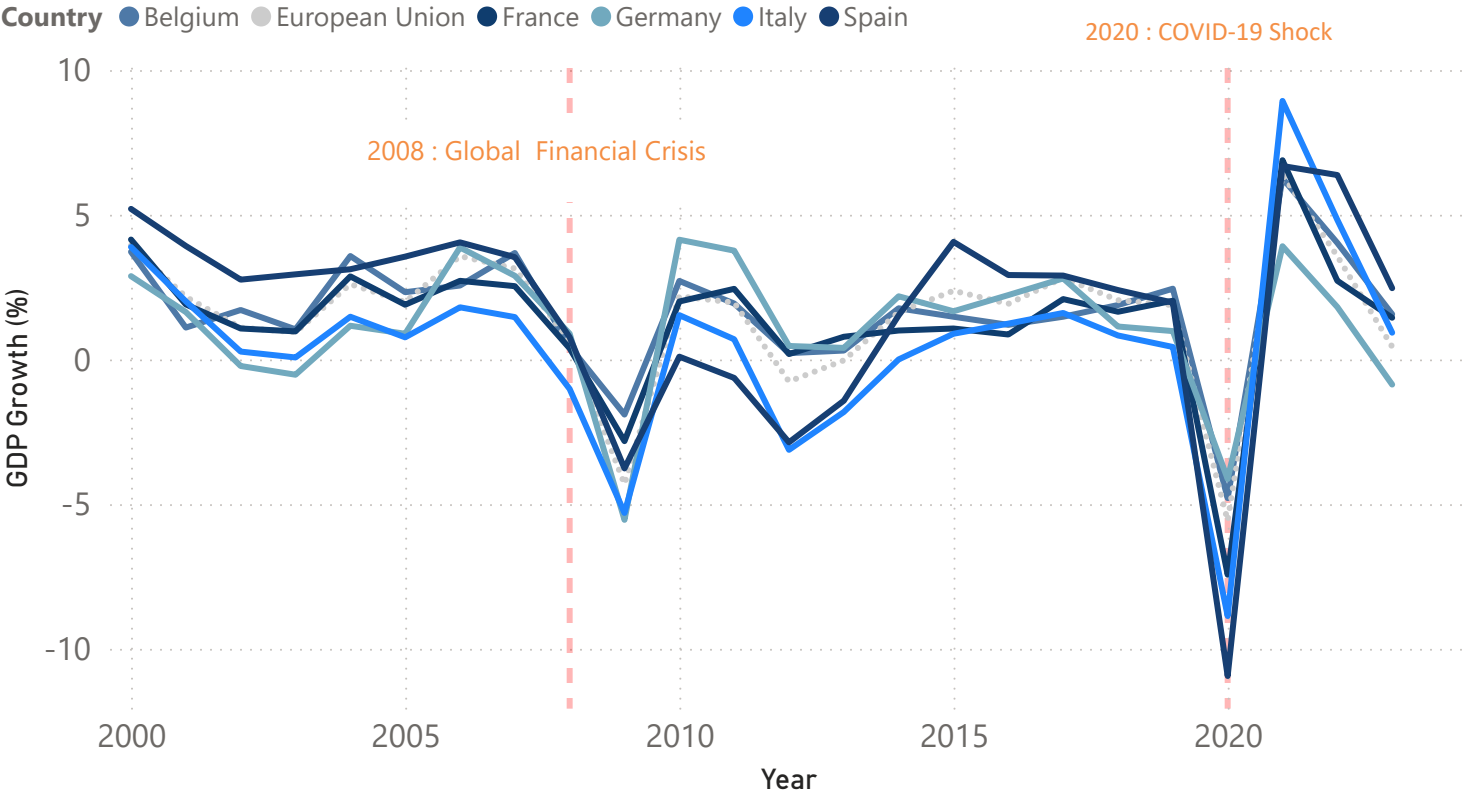
Average Unemployment Rate by Country



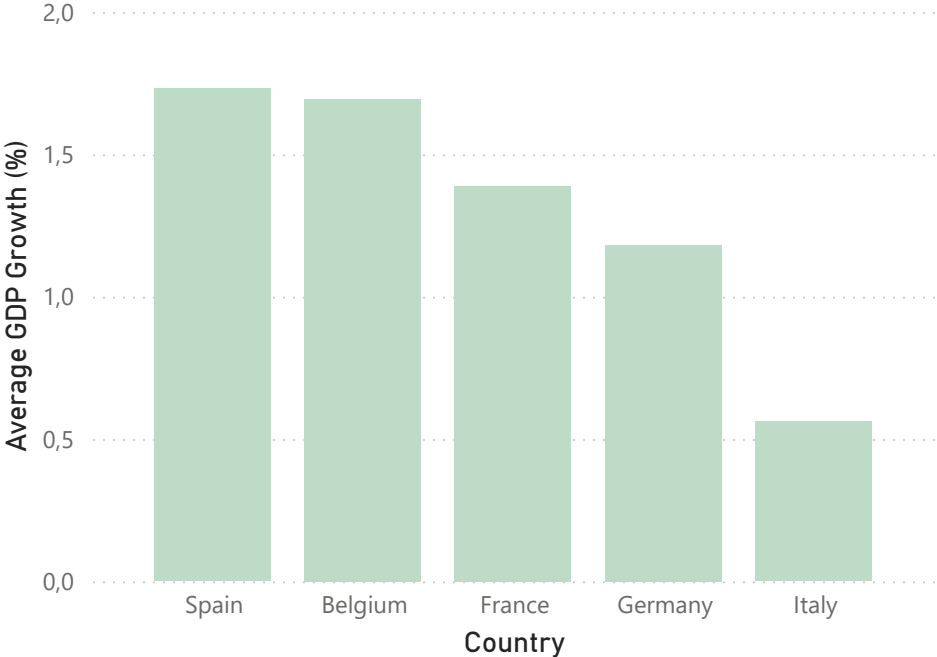
Source: World Development Indicators, World Bank.

GDP Growth (2000–2023)

Annual GDP Growth by Country



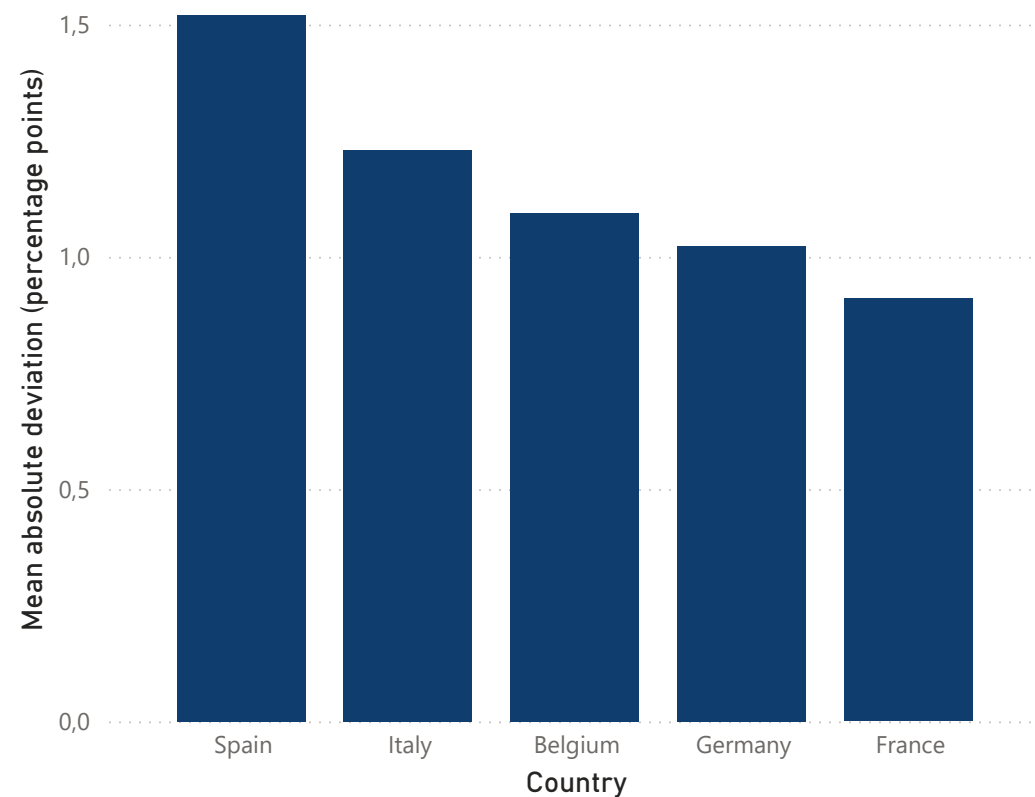
Average Annual GDP Growth by Country



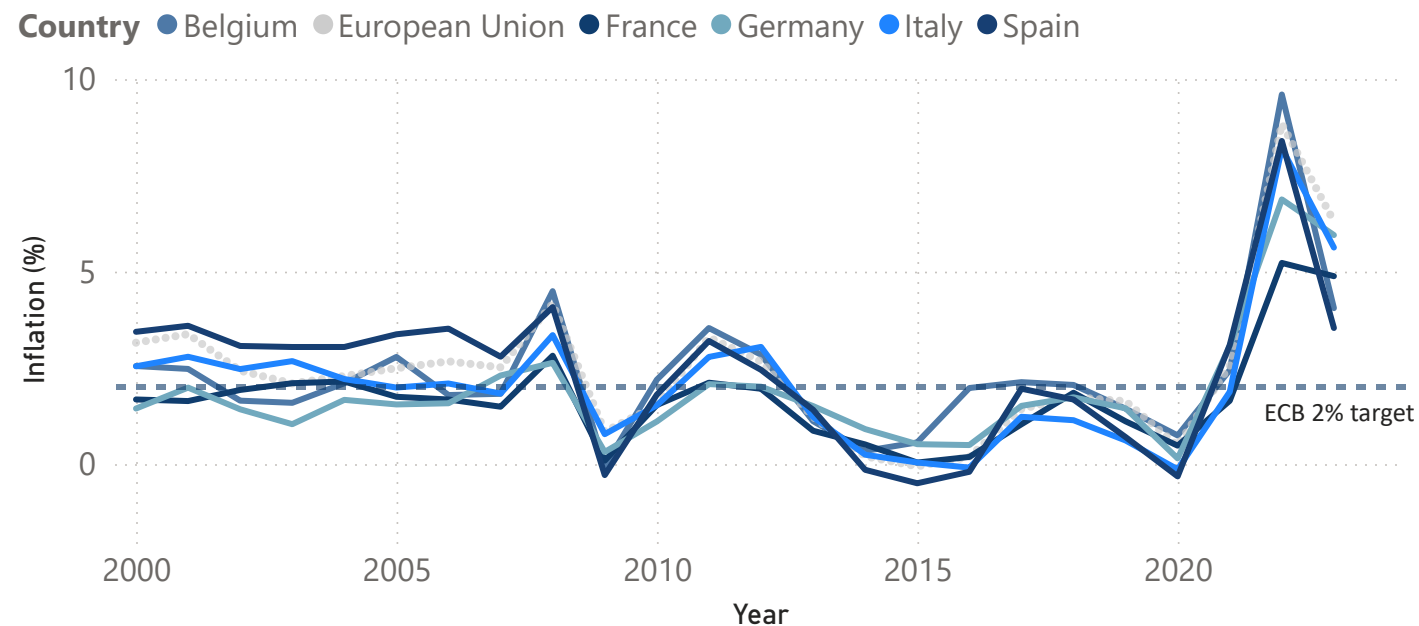
The five economies experienced common cyclical shocks, but their long-term performance differed substantially. Italy recorded the lowest average annual GDP growth, at approximately 0.56% over 2000–2023, while Spain experienced the deepest contraction in 2020 at approximately -10.94%.

Inflation (2000–2023)

Average Deviation from the ECB's 2% Target

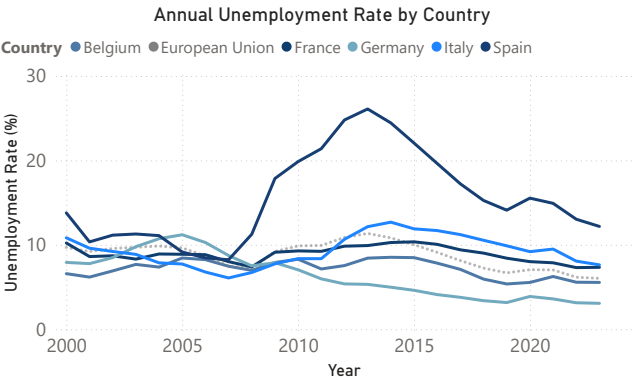


Annual Inflation Rate by Country

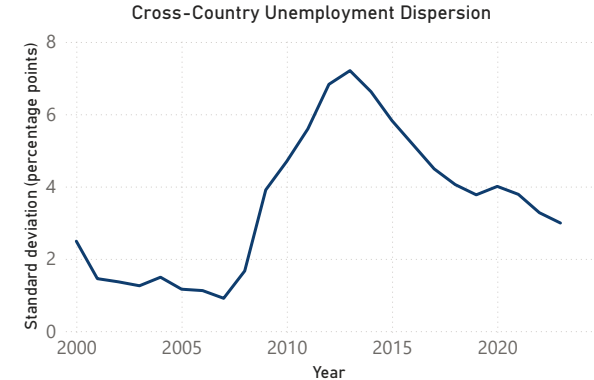


- France and Germany recorded the lowest average absolute deviations from the ECB's 2% target.
- Italy, Spain and Belgium all exceeded 8% inflation during the 2022 surge.

Unemployment (2000–2023)



- Strong structural divergence: Spain's unemployment rate peaked at 26% in 2013, while Germany fell below 4% by 2017 and remained near 3% in 2023.



- Before 2008, cross-country unemployment dispersion remained relatively low
- After the financial crisis, dispersion increased sharply and peaked at approximately 7 percentage points in 2013.
- Dispersion subsequently declined but remained above its pre-crisis level in 2023.

Source: World Development Indicators, World Bank.